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MAJORS & MINORS

International Studies

An International Studies degree fosters a global perspective, helping students navigate and address the pressing international issues of today's interconnected world.



Melissa Byrnes
Professor of History

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The International Studies program equips students with a broad understanding of other societies, cultures, and states. Our interdisciplinary curriculum investigates a wide variety of global systems—economic, social, religious, intellectual, political, aesthetic, and environmental—to gain insight into complex global challenges.

International Studies graduates are prepared for careers in business, government, non-governmental organizations, cultural heritage and preservation, education, politics, and law.

Majors take an introductory course in global, international, and/or comparative topics and methods. Students select one of three thematic global tracks to best suit their goals and interests.

- **Global Politics and Economy** courses focus on large structures, systems, and institutions.
- **Global Society and Culture** courses focus on people and communities.
- **Global Justice** courses are courses from either track that also have a Social Justice tag.

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International Studies is one of the Paideia Minors. Paideia provides intentional opportunities for students to integrate various academic disciplines and experiences, empowering them to develop versatile analytical abilities that lead them to become creative problem solvers who are well equipped to tackle complex issues. Paideia is not a traditional program but provides innovative, structured pathways that enable the acquisition of these invaluable skills.

All SU students are encouraged to graduate with Paideia Distinction by making Paideia a formal part of their studies. This requires completing either one of the Paideia Minors (or two High-Impact Experiences) and successfully completing a Paideia Seminar.

Graduation with Paideia Distinction formally recognizes students' cultivated curiosity to learn, integrate multiple viewpoints, and create change. The Paideia skills that students develop make SU graduates highly sought-after by recruiters, employers, and graduate programs.

Learn more about the [Paideia Seminar](#), how to apply for it, and how to graduate with [Paideia Distinction](#).

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Cultivating a Global Perspective

Recent alumna will pursue a dual degree master's program at world-renowned institutions.

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International Studies News

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Capstone Compass: Navigating the Research Journey- 2026 panels

2 separate panels of SU students who have successfully completed capstone level research will gather to reflect on their process and give advice to rising capstone students.

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